



CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

**SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE
EXAMINATION**

ENGLISH B

Paper 02 – General Proficiency

2 hours 10 minutes

11 JANUARY 2011 (a.m.)

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. This paper consists of TEN questions, arranged in three sections as follows:

SECTION A: DRAMA
 Questions 1 and 2: Shakespeare
 Questions 3 and 4: Modern Drama

SECTION B: POETRY
 Questions 5 and 6

SECTION C: PROSE FICTION
 Questions 7 to 10
2. ANSWER THREE QUESTIONS, ONE QUESTION FROM EACH SECTION.
3. Each question is worth a total of 35 marks.
4. You should use 10 minutes of the time allowed to read through the entire paper.

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For each question in Sections A, B and C, in addition to the 25 marks indicated for content and argument, a maximum of 10 marks is also allocated for structure, development and competence in the mechanics of writing.

Write in the ESSAY format and develop all your responses fully.

Read all instructions carefully before starting to write.

SECTION A – DRAMA

Answer ONE question in this section.

THE MERCHANT OF VENICE – William Shakespeare

EITHER

1. Consider the casket scenes in Portia's home in Belmont.
 - (a) Describe the test that has been set for Portia's suitors, and the consequences of their choosing wrongly. (8 marks)
 - (b) How was the casket test supposed to ensure that Portia married a man who would truly value her? (8 marks)
 - (c) How good a father is Shylock to Jessica when compared with Portia's father? (9 marks)

Total 25 marks

OR

2. In Act 4 Scene 1, Portia gives a speech in court about mercy.
 - (a) What advice does Portia give Shylock in this speech? (9 marks)
 - (b) What evidence is there in this scene to show that the Christians who preach mercy are themselves lacking this quality? (8 marks)
 - (c) Comment on the mercy that is shown to Shylock. (8 marks)

Total 25 marks

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FENCES – August Wilson**OR**

3. As the family meets for Troy's funeral, forgiveness for the past and hope for the future are evident.

(a) Discuss the ways in which Troy has wronged EACH of the following persons:

- (i) Rose
- (ii) Gabriel
- (iii) Cory

(18 marks)

(b) Show how forgiveness and hope are presented **dramatically** in the final scene of the play.
(7 marks)

Total 25 marks

OR

4. Rose is portrayed as a nurturing person.

(a) Discuss how Rose nurtured EACH of the following persons:

- (i) Troy
- (ii) Cory
- (iii) Raynell

(18 marks)

(b) Show how Rose was **both** hurt **and** blessed in her relationship with Troy. **(7 marks)**

Total 25 marks

SECTION B – POETRY

Answer ONE question in this section.

EITHER

- 5.** In the poems “From the Emigrants” and “Travelling Through the Dark”, a conflict is set up between Nature and technology.

For EACH poem:

- (a) Describe the situation in which Nature and technology are in conflict. **(8 marks)**
- (b) Identify ONE poetic device used to comment on the impact of technology on Nature, and comment on its effectiveness. **(8 marks)**
- (c) What message is EACH poet presenting through the portrayal of Nature and technology? **(9 marks)**

Total 25 marks

OR

- 6.** From the prescribed list of poems that you have studied, choose TWO in which the speaker comes face to face with the reality of death.

- (a) For EACH poem, describe the situation that causes the speaker to think about death. **(8 marks)**
- (b) Discuss the reaction of EACH speaker to this encounter with death. **(9 marks)**
- (c) Identify ONE poetic device which is used to convey the thoughts and feelings of the speaker in EACH poem and comment on its effectiveness. **(8 marks)**

Total 25 marks

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SECTION C – PROSE FICTION

Answer ONE question in this section.

You MUST state the title of any books you refer to in your answer.

You should refer ONLY to the books that are on the prescribed list for this section of the examination.

EITHER

- 7.** “Societies are made up of people with power and people who are powerless.”

Discuss how a MAJOR character in ONE West Indian and ONE non-West Indian novel you have studied is oppressed by the power of another person or an institution AND struggles against oppression in a bid for freedom. **(25 marks)**

OR

- 8.** Select ONE West Indian and ONE non-West Indian novel in which a MAJOR character dreams of a better life. For EACH novel, discuss the struggles which that character goes through in attempting to make those dreams come true. **(25 marks)**

OR

- 9.** “A good friend is better than money.”

Discuss the extent to which this statement applies to a MAJOR character in ONE West Indian and ONE non-West Indian novel you have studied. **(25 marks)**

OR

- 10.** Select ONE West Indian and ONE non-West Indian novel you have studied and discuss the effectiveness of the title of EACH novel. **(25 marks)**

END OF TEST